

7 INNINGS, 4 HOMERS!

Bears' Roberts Had 'Lucky' Day

By HALSEY HALL

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There are two things about Curt Roberts, talented second-sacker of the Denver Bears. One—he is one of the few men who ever hit four home runs in a seven-inning game, maybe the only one. Two—he has nice words about Bobby Bragan, the now embattled manager of the Pittsburgh Pirates.



Roberts

You may not think a guy could be lucky in hitting four homers, but that's the way Curt modestly dismisses it. "It was in Columbus last year in the International league. I hit three over the left field fence and one inside the park to right-center. That sure was my luckiest day.

"Bragan? Yes, I played for Bobby at Hollywood on the Coast and with Pittsburgh. He's not exactly the easy type; but he's a pretty nice guy. He wants you to give all you have while you're out there. I'd say he's a good manager.

"I like him myself and you know you can't handle 25 men all the same. You've

got to figure 'em out. I was with Fred Haney at Pitt, then Bragan at Hollywood.

"Went from high school to the Kansas City Monarchs and played there with Hank Thompson, Gene Baker and Ernie Banks. Guess I traveled around the infield some. Played second, third and short. Played second with Banks at short."

Curt's doing a repeat at Denver. He was there in the Western loop in 1951 when Andy Cohen was the manager. Roberts grinned. "All that Cohen could talk about was what a great town Minneapolis is and how happy he was here.

"Been traded some, too. Went to Kansas City from Pittsburgh, then the As sent me to Kansas City as part of that deal they made with the Yanks. I always planned to go to college when I got out of high school but I got the offer with the Monarchs.

"Then, when I saw Negroes getting a chance in organized ball, I thought I'd follow it farther. That Negro league had some guys who could play triple A ball, but a lot who couldn't even play A ball. So here I am."